

Major suit raises

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Major suit bids. The Major suits are Hearts and Spades.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

you need 26 points to make game (4♥ 4♠)

you need 33 points to make slam (6♥ 6♠)

open 1♥ or 1♠ with 13-21 points at least five of the suit

respond by raising to 2-level with 6-10 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 3-level with 11-12 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 13-16 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 8-12 points and at least five of the suit

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 1♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠K

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣5

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♦10

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥10

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 5 4 2
♥ J 10
♦ A 10 9 6 5
♣ A J

♠ A
♥ K Q 9 8 7 4 2
♦ K Q
♣ K 4 2



♠ K Q 9 7
♥ A 5
♦ 7 2
♣ Q 10 9 6 3

♠ J 8 6 3
♥ 6 3
♦ J 8 4 3
♣ 8 7 5

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

All Pass

1 ♥ by North

Lead: ♠ K

NORTH has 20 points because she gets to add one point each for her fifth, sixth and seventh ♥s. So she opens 1 ♥.

SOUTH, with just 2 points, would have passed almost anything NORTH bid. Certainly he passes the 1 ♥ bid.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 8 4 2
 ♥ 9 7 6
 ♦ Q J
 ♣ A K 7 2

♠ 9 3

♥ 8 4 3

♦ A 9 6 5 4

♣ J 10 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 10 6 5

♥ K Q 2

♦ K 8 7

♣ 8 3

♠ A 7

♥ A J 10 5

♦ 10 3 2

♣ Q 9 5 4

*West**North**East**South*

3 ♠

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

Lead: ♣5

EAST has 14 points so he opens one of his 5-card Major suit, 1 ♠.

WEST has some good ♣s, but with four of partner's Major she doesn't bother bidding anything else. Since she has 11 points she jumps to 3 ♠, a Limit Raise.

EAST is very close to passing. He now gets to add a point for his doubleton ♣ which takes him up to 15 points. So he has enough to bid 4 ♠.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 6
♥ Q 4 3
♦ 10 9 7 6
♣ A J 9 8

♠ 10 9 5 3

♥ K J 2

♦ A 5

♣ K 7 4 2



♠ A 4

♥ 10 7 6 5

♦ 8 4 3 2

♣ Q 10 3

♠ K J 8 7 2

♥ A 9 8

♦ K Q J

♣ 6 5

SOUTH has a normal opening bid of 1♠.

NORTH has a Limit Raise in ♠s, 11 points and 4 ♠s. He responds 3♠

SOUTH figures that 15 points is enough for game with partner showing 11/12. She bids 4♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♦ 10			

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 6

♥ A Q 8 7 6 4 2

♦ A 3

♣ 4 2

♠ J 7 2

♥ 10 9

♦ K Q J 8 4

♣ A 10 3



♠ 5 4 3

♥ K 5 3

♦ 10 6 5

♣ Q J 8 5

♠ K Q 10 9 8

♥ J

♦ 9 7 2

♣ K 9 7 6

EAST has 6 points and wouldn't dream of opening.

WEST has 17 points, counting three extra length points, so she opens 1♥.

EAST does have enough to raise to 2♥.

WEST makes one more try, inviting with a 3♥ bid but EAST just passes.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

2♥

Pass

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by West

Lead: ♥10